

24 Naive Bayes Classification

We have seen how to fit Bayesian regression models for predicting numerical variables. Now we will introduce a Bayesian *classification* method for predicting *categorical* variables. The goal is to “classify” observations according to which category (class) they belong to.

This handout corresponds to [Chapter 14](#) of (Johnson et al. 2022).

There exist multiple penguin species throughout Antarctica, including the *Adelie* (A), *Chinstrap* (C), and *Gentoo* (G). Our goal will be to classify penguins according to their species given characteristics like weight or bill length. (Throughout “penguin” refers to an Antarctic penguin of one of these three species.)

Example 24.1. Suppose first that we have no information about a randomly selected penguin (other than it’s an Antarctic penguin from one of these three species).

1. How might we formulate a prior distribution for the species of the penguin? Would we necessarily assume equal prior probability for the three species?
2. Suppose that among Antarctic penguins of these three species, 44.2% of Adelie, 19.8% are Chinstrap, and 36.0% are Gentoo. Start to set up a Bayes table.

Example 24.2. Now suppose we know that a randomly selected penguin is below average weight (that is, below 4200g).

1. What is the next column of the Bayes table to fill in? What information would we need to do so?

2. Suppose that 83.4% of Adelie penguins are below average weight, 89.7% of Chinstrap penguins are below average weight, and 4.9% of Gentoo penguins are below average weight. Among these three species, the likelihood of being below average weight is greatest for Chinstrap. Does that mean we should necessarily classify the penguin to be Chinstrap? Why?
3. Complete the Bayes table and find the posterior probability of each species given that the penguin is below average weight.
4. If the penguin is below average weight, what species would you classify it as? Why?
5. Now suppose the the penguin is not below average weight. Compute the posterior probability of each species given that the penguin is not below average weight. What species would you classify it as? Why?
6. Suppose that you classify any randomly selected penguin based on whether or not it is below average weight. What is the posterior probability that you classify the penguin correctly?

Example 24.3. Now suppose we know that a randomly selected penguin has a bill length of 50mm. We'll start by assuming we don't know yet whether or not it is below average weight.

1. Start to create a Bayes table. What is the prior? What is the next column of the Bayes table to fill in? What information would we need to do so?
2. Suppose that bill lengths (mm) follow a $N(38.8, 2.66)$ distribution for Adelie, a $N(48.8, 3.34)$ distribution for Chinstrap, and a $N(47.5, 3.08)$ distribution for Gentoo. How would you fill in the likelihood column?
3. Among these three species, the likelihood of having of a 50mm bill is greatest for Chinstrap. Does that mean we should necessarily classify the penguin to be Chinstrap? Why?
4. Complete the Bayes table and find the posterior probability of each species given that the penguin has a 50mm bill.
5. If the species has a 50mm bill, what species would you classify it as? Why?

6. Now suppose before measuring bill length we had already known that the penguin was below average weight. How would our Bayes table have changed? If we don't change the likelihood column, what are we assuming?

7. Compute the posterior probability of each species given that the penguin is below average weight with a 50mm bill, assuming conditional independence between weight and bill length. Given a species with these characteristics, what species would you classify it as? Why?

- **Naive Bayes classification** uses Bayes rule to predict the class of a categorical response variable y given predictor variables $x_1, \dots, x_p$
- Predictor variables can be categorical or numerical
- Naive Bayes classification assumes that predictors are *conditionally independent* given each class
- Naive Bayes classification typically assumes that any numerical predictor variable is conditionally Normal
- Given observed data
 - Prior probabilities for the response variable are estimated to be the observed sample proportion for each class
 - For a categorical predictor x , the likelihood of value $\tilde{x}$ is estimated to be the observed sample proportion of $\tilde{x}$ within each class
 - For a numerical predictor x , the likelihood is computed assuming that within each class values of the predictor follow a Normal distribution with mean and SD estimated to be the sample mean and SD within each class.

Example 24.4. Now suppose we know that a penguin has a bill length of 50mm and a flipper length of 195mm. (We'll ignore whether or not it is below average weight for this example.)

1. Starting with our original prior, what is the “evidence” that the likelihood is based on? What information do we need to fill in the likelihood column?

2. Suppose that flipper lengths (mm) follow a $N(190, 6.54)$ distribution for Adelie, a $N(196, 7.13)$ distribution for Chinstrap, and a $N(217, 6.48)$ distribution for Gentoo. (Recall that bill lengths (mm) follow a $N(38.8, 2.66)$ distribution for Adelie, a $N(48.8, 3.34)$ distribution for Chinstrap, and a $N(47.5, 3.08)$ distribution for Gentoo.) How would you fill in the likelihood column? What are we assuming?
3. Complete the Bayes table and find the posterior probability of each species given that the penguin has a 50mm bill and a 195mm flipper.
4. If the species has a 50mm bill and a 195mm flipper, what species would you classify it as? Why?

24.1 Notes

24.1.1 Given below average weight

```
class = c("A", "C", "G")  
  
prior = c(0.442, 0.198, 0.360)  
  
# likelihood of below average weight (evidence) given each species (class)
```

class	prior	likelihood	product	posterior
A	0.442	0.834	0.3686	0.6537
C	0.198	0.897	0.1776	0.3150
G	0.360	0.049	0.0176	0.0313
Total	1.000	1.780	0.5639	1.0000

```
likelihood = c(0.834, 0.897, 0.049)

product = prior * likelihood

posterior = product / sum(product)

posterior_given_below_average_weight = posterior

bayes_table = data.frame(class,
                          prior,
                          likelihood,
                          product,
                          posterior)

bayes_table |>
  adorn_totals("row") |>
  kbl(digits = 4) |>
  kable_styling()
```

24.1.2 Given not below average weight

```
class = c("A", "C", "G")

prior = c(0.442, 0.198, 0.360)

# likelihood of not below average weight (evidence) given each species (class)
likelihood = c(1 - 0.834, 1 - 0.897, 1 - 0.049)

product = prior * likelihood

posterior = product / sum(product)

bayes_table = data.frame(class,
```

class	prior	likelihood	product	posterior
A	0.442	0.166	0.0734	0.1682
C	0.198	0.103	0.0204	0.0468
G	0.360	0.951	0.3424	0.7850
Total	1.000	1.220	0.4361	1.0000

```

                                prior,
                                likelihood,
                                product,
                                posterior)

bayes_table |>
  adorn_totals("row") |>
  kbl(digits = 4) |>
  kable_styling()

```

24.1.3 Given 50mm bill

```

class = c("A", "C", "G")

prior = c(0.442, 0.198, 0.360)

# likelihood of 50mm bill (evidence) given each species (class)
likelihood = c(dnorm(50, 38.8, 2.66),
               dnorm(50, 48.8, 3.34),
               dnorm(50, 47.5, 3.08))

product = prior * likelihood

posterior = product / sum(product)

bayes_table = data.frame(class,
                          prior,
                          likelihood,
                          product,
                          posterior)

bayes_table |>
  adorn_totals("row") |>

```

class	prior	likelihood	product	posterior
A	0.442	0.0000	0.0000	0.0002
C	0.198	0.1120	0.0222	0.3979
G	0.360	0.0932	0.0335	0.6019
Total	1.000	0.2052	0.0557	1.0000

```
kbl(digits = 4) |>
kable_styling()
```

24.1.4 Given 50mm bill and below average weight

```
class = c("A", "C", "G")

prior = posterior_given_below_average_weight

# likelihood of 50mm (evidence) given each species (class)
likelihood = c(dnorm(50, 38.8, 2.66),
               dnorm(50, 48.8, 3.34),
               dnorm(50, 47.5, 3.08))

product = prior * likelihood

posterior = product / sum(product)

bayes_table = data.frame(class,
                          prior,
                          likelihood,
                          product,
                          posterior)

bayes_table |>
  adorn_totals("row") |>
  kbl(digits = 4) |>
  kable_styling()
```


class	prior	likelihood	product	posterior
A	0.6537	0.0000	0.0000	0.0004
C	0.3150	0.1120	0.0353	0.9233
G	0.0313	0.0932	0.0029	0.0763
Total	1.0000	0.2052	0.0382	1.0000

24.1.5 Given 50mm bill and 195mm flipper

```

class = c("A", "C", "G")

prior = c(0.442, 0.198, 0.360)

# likelihood of 50mm bill (evidence) given each species (class)
likelihood_bill = c(dnorm(50, 38.8, 2.66),
                    dnorm(50, 48.8, 3.34),
                    dnorm(50, 47.5, 3.08))

# likelihood of 195mm flipper (evidence) given each species (class)
likelihood_flipper = c(dnorm(195, 190, 6.54),
                      dnorm(195, 196, 7.13),
                      dnorm(195, 217, 6.48))

# assume conditional independence of bill and flipper given species (class)
likelihood = likelihood_bill * likelihood_flipper

product = prior * likelihood

posterior = product / sum(product)

bayes_table = data.frame(class,
                          prior,
                          likelihood_bill,
                          likelihood_flipper,
                          likelihood,
                          product,
                          posterior)

bayes_table |>
  adorn_totals("row") |>
  kbl(digits = 6) |>
  kable_styling()

```

class	prior	likelihood_bill	likelihood_flipper	likelihood	product	posterior
A	0.442	0.000021	0.045542	0.000001	0.000000	0.000345
C	0.198	0.111978	0.055405	0.006204	0.001228	0.994404
G	0.360	0.093174	0.000193	0.000018	0.000006	0.005251
Total	1.000	0.205173	0.101140	0.006223	0.001235	1.000000

24.1.6 Data

This code is taken from [Chapter 14](#) of (Johnson et al. 2022).

```
library(bayesrules)
```

Warning: package 'bayesrules' was built under R version 4.5.3

```
# Load data
data(penguins_bayes)
penguins <- penguins_bayes

head(penguins)
```

```
# A tibble: 6 x 9
  species island   year bill_length_mm bill_depth_mm flipper_length_mm
  <fct>   <fct>   <int>         <dbl>         <dbl>             <int>
1 Adelie Torgersen  2007          39.1          18.7             181
2 Adelie Torgersen  2007          39.5          17.4             186
3 Adelie Torgersen  2007          40.3           18             195
4 Adelie Torgersen  2007           NA           NA              NA
5 Adelie Torgersen  2007          36.7          19.3             193
6 Adelie Torgersen  2007          39.3          20.6             190
# i 3 more variables: body_mass_g <int>, above_average_weight <fct>, sex <fct>
```

Estimated prior distribution

```
penguins |>
  tabyl(species)
```

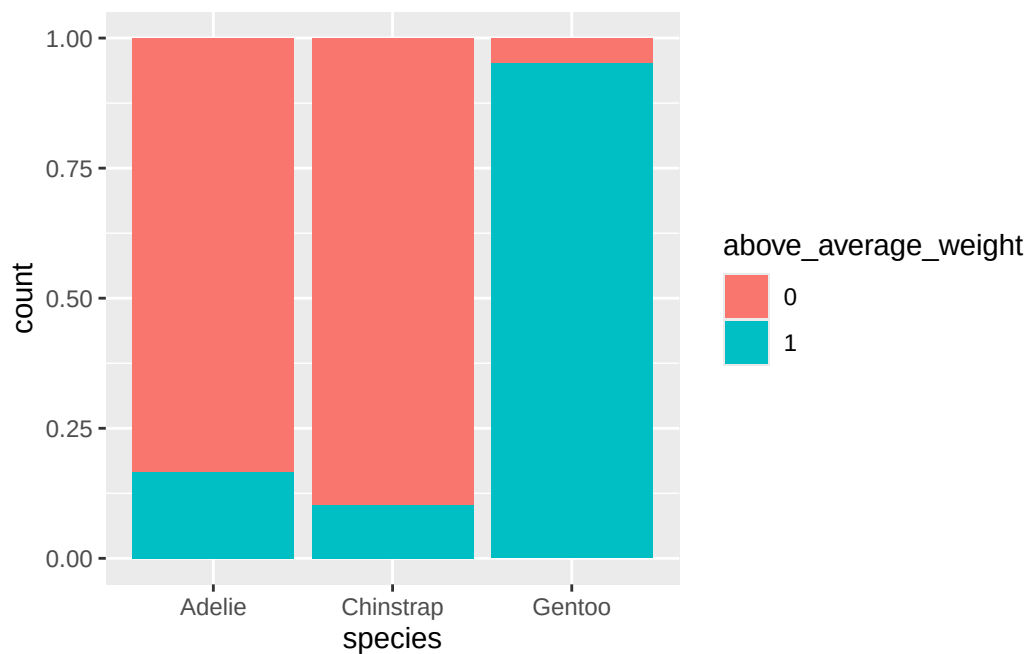
```
  species    n  percent
  Adelie  152 0.4418605
Chinstrap   68 0.1976744
  Gentoo  124 0.3604651
```

Estimated likelihood of below average weight

```
penguins |>
  select(species, above_average_weight) |>
  na.omit() |>
  tabyl(species, above_average_weight) |>
  adorn_totals(c("row", "col"))
```

species	0	1	Total
Adelie	126	25	151
Chinstrap	61	7	68
Gentoo	6	117	123
Total	193	149	342

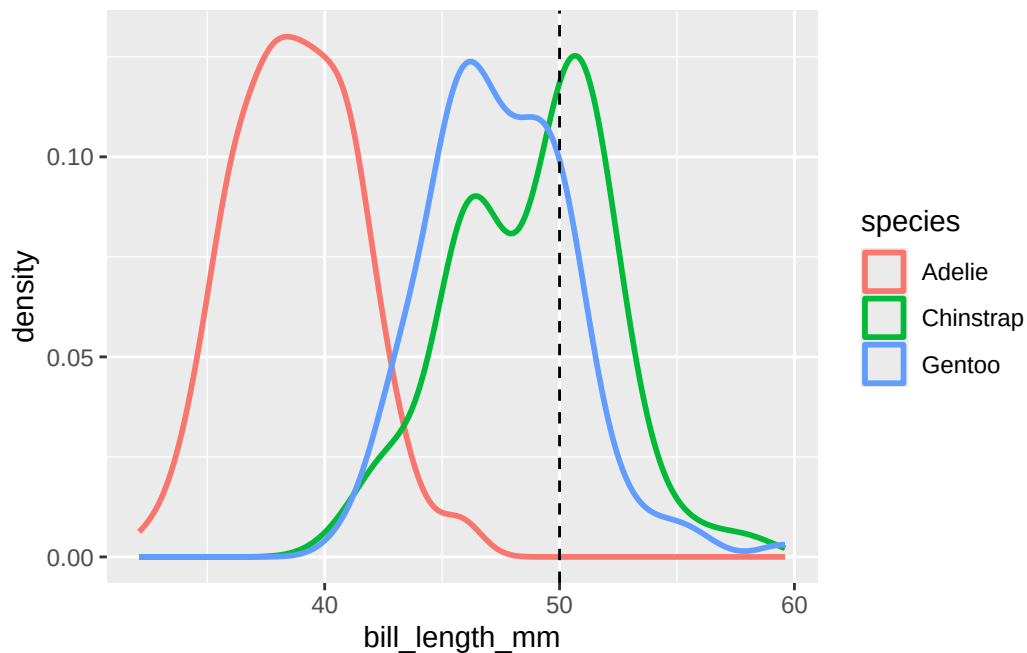
```
ggplot(penguins |>
  drop_na(above_average_weight),
  aes(fill = above_average_weight,
      x = species)) +
  geom_bar(position = "fill")
```



Estimated likelihood of 50mm bill

```
ggplot(penguins,
       aes(x = bill_length_mm,
           col = species)) +
  geom_density(linewidth = 1) +
  geom_vline(xintercept = 50, linetype = "dashed")
```

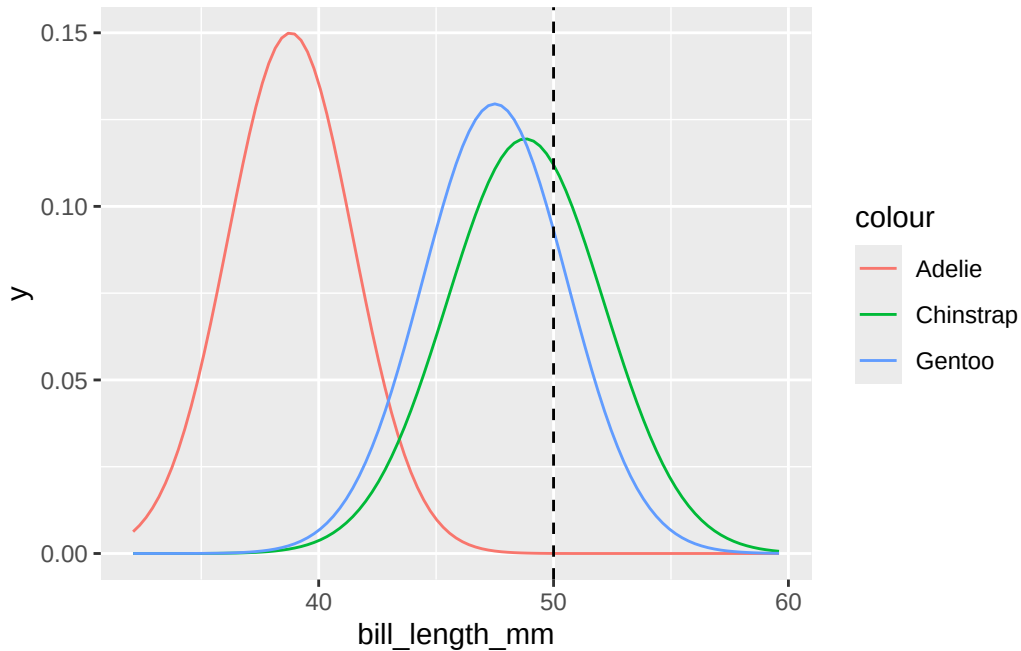
Warning: Removed 2 rows containing non-finite outside the scale range (`stat\_density()`).



```
penguins |>
  group_by(species) |>
  summarize(mean = mean(bill_length_mm, na.rm = TRUE),
            sd = sd(bill_length_mm, na.rm = TRUE))
```

```
# A tibble: 3 x 3
  species    mean    sd
  <fct>    <dbl> <dbl>
1 Adelie   38.8  2.66
2 Chinstrap 48.8  3.34
3 Gentoo   47.5  3.08
```

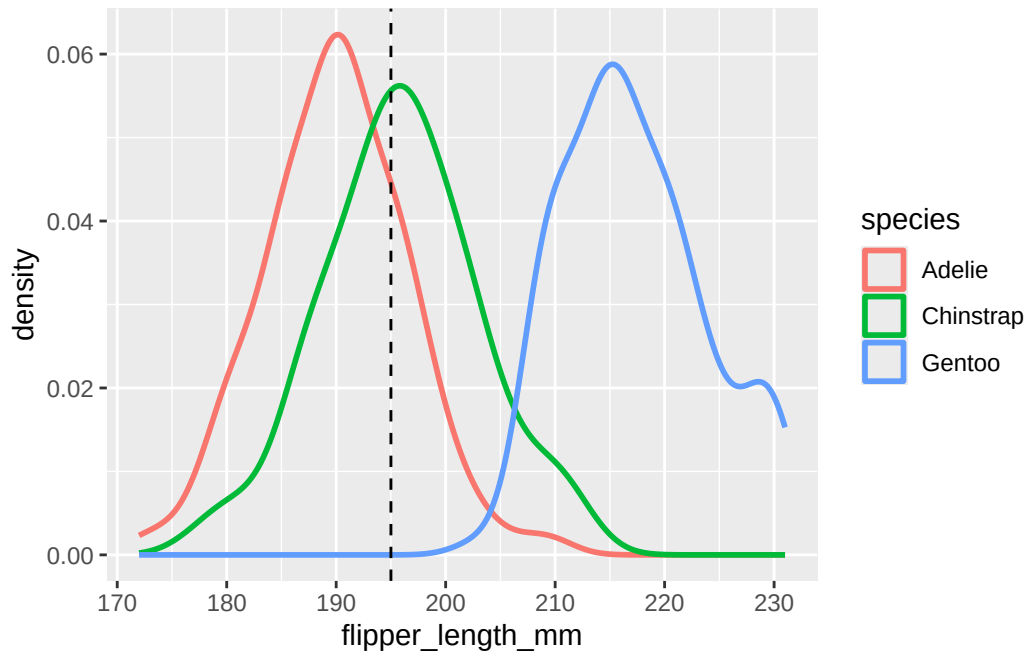
```
ggplot(penguins, aes(x = bill_length_mm, color = species)) +
  stat_function(fun = dnorm, args = list(mean = 38.8, sd = 2.66),
    aes(color = "Adelie")) +
  stat_function(fun = dnorm, args = list(mean = 48.8, sd = 3.34),
    aes(color = "Chinstrap")) +
  stat_function(fun = dnorm, args = list(mean = 47.5, sd = 3.08),
    aes(color = "Gentoo")) +
  geom_vline(xintercept = 50, linetype = "dashed")
```



Estimated likelihood of 195mm bill

```
ggplot(penguins,
  aes(x = flipper_length_mm,
    col = species)) +
  geom_density(linewidth = 1) +
  geom_vline(xintercept = 195, linetype = "dashed")
```

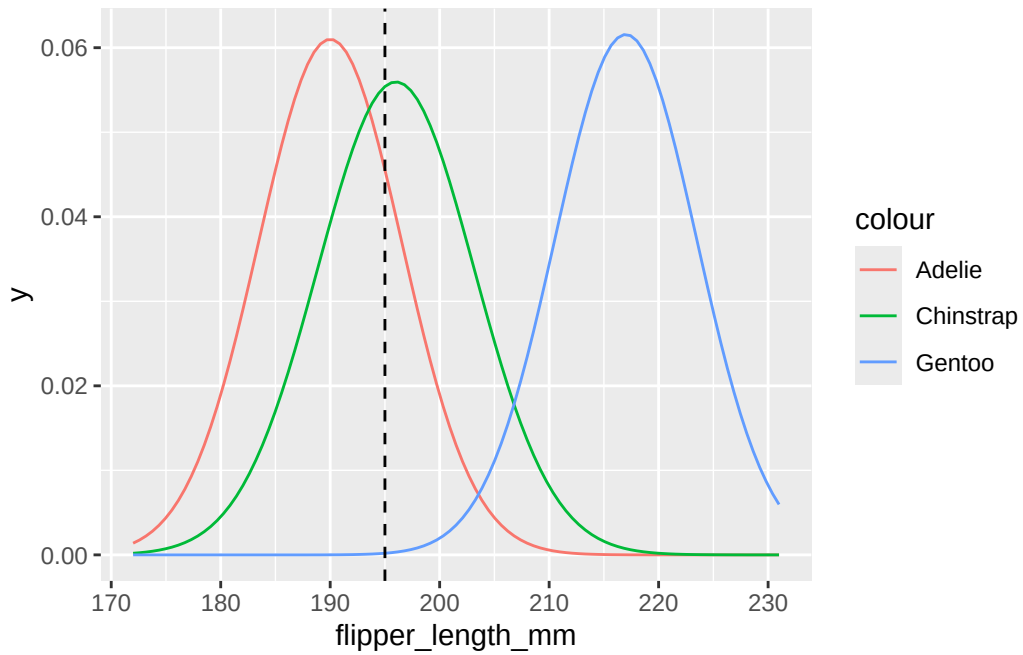
Warning: Removed 2 rows containing non-finite outside the scale range
(`stat\_density()`).



```
penguins |>
  group_by(species) |>
  summarize(mean = mean(flipper_length_mm, na.rm = TRUE),
            sd = sd(flipper_length_mm, na.rm = TRUE))
```

```
# A tibble: 3 x 3
  species    mean    sd
  <fct>    <dbl> <dbl>
1 Adelie   190.   6.54
2 Chinstrap 196.   7.13
3 Gentoo   217.   6.48
```

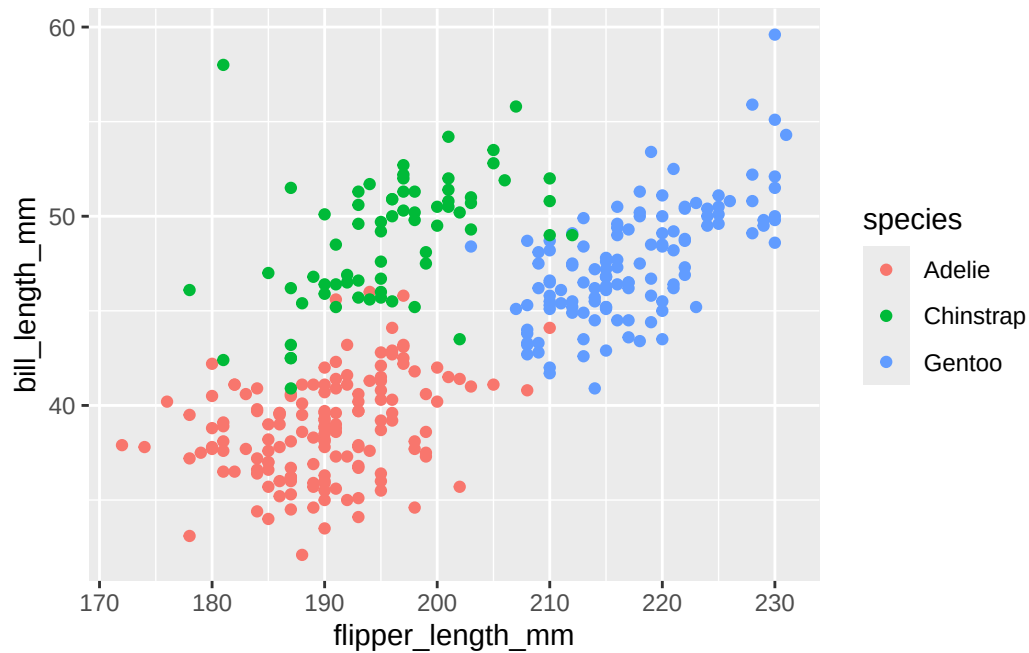
```
ggplot(penguins,
       aes(x = flipper_length_mm,
           color = species)) +
  stat_function(fun = dnorm, args = list(mean = 190, sd = 6.54),
               aes(color = "Adelie")) +
  stat_function(fun = dnorm, args = list(mean = 196, sd = 7.13),
               aes(color = "Chinstrap")) +
  stat_function(fun = dnorm, args = list(mean = 217, sd = 6.48),
               aes(color = "Gentoo")) +
  geom_vline(xintercept = 195, linetype = "dashed")
```



Flipper length and bill length

```
ggplot(penguins,  
  aes(x = flipper_length_mm,  
    y = bill_length_mm,  
    color = species)) +  
  geom_point()
```

Warning: Removed 2 rows containing missing values or values outside the scale range (`geom\_point()`).



24.1.7 Naive Bayes Classification with e1071 package

```
library(e1071)
```

Warning: package 'e1071' was built under R version 4.5.3

Attaching package: 'e1071'

The following object is masked from 'package:ggplot2':

element

```
our_penguin <- data.frame(above_average_weight = "0",  
                           bill_length_mm = 50,  
                           flipper_length_mm = 195)
```


24.1.7.1 Given below average weight

```
naive_model_weight = naiveBayes(species ~ above_average_weight,  
                                data = penguins)  
  
naive_model_weight
```

Naive Bayes Classifier for Discrete Predictors

Call:

```
naiveBayes.default(x = X, y = Y, laplace = laplace)
```

A-priori probabilities:

Y

	Adelie	Chinstrap	Gentoo
	0.4418605	0.1976744	0.3604651

Conditional probabilities:

	above_average_weight	
Y	0	1
Adelie	0.83443709	0.16556291
Chinstrap	0.89705882	0.10294118
Gentoo	0.04878049	0.95121951

```
predict(naive_model_weight,  
        newdata = our_penguin,  
        type = "raw")
```

	Adelie	Chinstrap	Gentoo
[1,]	0.6541796	0.3146224	0.03119806

24.1.7.2 Given 50mm bill

```
naive_model_bill = naiveBayes(species ~ bill_length_mm,  
                              data = penguins)  
  
naive_model_bill
```

Naive Bayes Classifier for Discrete Predictors

Call:

```
naiveBayes.default(x = X, y = Y, laplace = laplace)
```

A-priori probabilities:

Y

	Adelie	Chinstrap	Gentoo
	0.4418605	0.1976744	0.3604651

Conditional probabilities:

		bill_length_mm
Y		
		[,1] [,2]
Adelie	38.79139	2.663405
Chinstrap	48.83382	3.339256
Gentoo	47.50488	3.081857

```
predict(naive_model_bill,  
        newdata = our_penguin,  
        type = "raw")
```

	Adelie	Chinstrap	Gentoo
[1,]	0.0001690279	0.3978306	0.6020004

24.1.7.3 Given 50mm bill and below average weight

```
naive_model_weight_and_bill = naiveBayes(species ~ above_average_weight + bill_length_mm,  
                                          data = penguins)  
  
naive_model_weight_and_bill
```

Naive Bayes Classifier for Discrete Predictors

Call:

```
naiveBayes.default(x = X, y = Y, laplace = laplace)
```

A-priori probabilities:

Y	Adelie	Chinstrap	Gentoo
	0.4418605	0.1976744	0.3604651

Conditional probabilities:

	above_average_weight	
Y	0	1
Adelie	0.83443709	0.16556291
Chinstrap	0.89705882	0.10294118
Gentoo	0.04878049	0.95121951

	bill_length_mm	
Y	[,1]	[,2]
Adelie	38.79139	2.663405
Chinstrap	48.83382	3.339256
Gentoo	47.50488	3.081857

```
predict(naive_model_weight_and_bill,
        newdata = our_penguin,
        type = "raw")
```

	Adelie	Chinstrap	Gentoo
[1,]	0.0003650334	0.9236333	0.07600171

24.1.7.4 Given 50mm bill and 195mm flipper

```
naive_model_flipper_and_bill = naiveBayes(species ~ flipper_length_mm + bill_length_mm,
                                           data = penguins)

naive_model_flipper_and_bill
```

Naive Bayes Classifier for Discrete Predictors

Call:

```
naiveBayes.default(x = X, y = Y, laplace = laplace)
```

A-priori probabilities:

Y	Adelie	Chinstrap	Gentoo
---	--------	-----------	--------

```
0.4418605 0.1976744 0.3604651
```

Conditional probabilities:

```
      flipper_length_mm
Y      [,1]      [,2]
Adelie  189.9536  6.539457
Chinstrap 195.8235  7.131894
Gentoo   217.1870  6.484976
```

```
      bill_length_mm
Y      [,1]      [,2]
Adelie   38.79139  2.663405
Chinstrap 48.83382  3.339256
Gentoo   47.50488  3.081857
```

```
predict(naive_model_flipper_and_bill,
        newdata = our_penguin,
        type = "raw")
```

```
      Adelie Chinstrap      Gentoo
[1,] 0.0003445688 0.9948681 0.004787365
```

24.1.7.5 Evaluation of flipper length and bill length model

Can classify each of the penguins in the data set

```
penguins <- penguins %>%
  mutate(predicted_species = predict(naive_model_flipper_and_bill, newdata = .))
```

```
penguins |>
  select(bill_length_mm, flipper_length_mm, species, predicted_species) |>
  head(10) |>
  kbl() |> kable_styling()
```

Then check classification against actual species to see how well the classification algorithm works within the sample.

```
penguins |>
  tabyl(species, predicted_species) |>
  adorn_percentages("row") |>
```

bill_length_mm	flipper_length_mm	species	predicted_species
39.1	181	Adelie	Adelie
39.5	186	Adelie	Adelie
40.3	195	Adelie	Adelie
NA	NA	Adelie	Adelie
36.7	193	Adelie	Adelie
39.3	190	Adelie	Adelie
38.9	181	Adelie	Adelie
39.2	195	Adelie	Adelie
34.1	193	Adelie	Adelie
42.0	190	Adelie	Adelie

```
adorn_pct_formatting(digits = 2) |>
adorn_ns()
```

species	Adelie	Chinstrap	Gentoo
Adelie	96.05% (146)	2.63% (4)	1.32% (2)
Chinstrap	7.35% (5)	86.76% (59)	5.88% (4)
Gentoo	0.81% (1)	0.81% (1)	98.39

(122)

We can use cross-validation to estimate how well our algorithm would classify new penguins outside of the data set.

```
naive_cv <-
  naive_classification_summary_cv(model = naive_model_flipper_and_bill,
                                data = penguins,
                                y = "species",
                                k = 10)

naive_cv$cv
```

species	Adelie	Chinstrap	Gentoo
Adelie	96.05% (146)	2.63% (4)	1.32% (2)
Chinstrap	7.35% (5)	86.76% (59)	5.88% (4)
Gentoo	0.81% (1)	0.81% (1)	98.39

(122)